



“You may
encounter
many defeats
**but you
must not be
defeated.”**

MAYA ANGELOU, POET AND CIVIL RIGHTS ACTIVIST

RESISTING RACISM AND OPPRESSION

Known for her artistic achievements, Maya Angelou was also involved as a fund-raiser for the Civil Rights Movement (see pp. 266–267) in the 1960s, and organized mass participation in boycotts and marches. In 1960, she heard one of Martin Luther King, Jr.’s speeches in Harlem, New York, and went on to become a friend of both him and Malcolm X. Heartbroken by King’s assassination in 1968, she wrote her autobiography *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings* (1969). Her writing was a voice of strength and hope that inspired generations of people to resist racism and oppression. Here, Civil Rights activists protest discriminatory hiring practices in Angelou’s adopted hometown of New York in 1963.